

Chapter 8: The Silence She Chose

The next morning didn't feel like morning.

It felt like something had ended.

Luna opened her eyes slowly.

The ceiling stared back at her.

Same room.

Same walls.

Same life.

But something was missing.

Something... that made everything else feel pointless.

Her hand moved slightly across the bed.

Empty.

Of course it was empty.

Still—

Her fingers stayed there for a moment longer.

Like they were hoping to find something that wasn't there.

“Kyros...”

His name escaped before she could stop it.

Her voice sounded unfamiliar.

Weak.

She turned to her side.

Curled into herself.

Pulling the blanket closer.

As if that could replace warmth.

As if that could replace him.

“I’m okay...” she whispered.

But the words felt wrong.

Heavy.

Like a lie she couldn’t believe.

The day passed.

Or maybe it didn't.

Time didn't feel real anymore.

Her mother called her.

She didn't respond.

Her phone kept buzzing.

She didn't check.

Food was placed near her.

Untouched.

Everything felt distant.

Muted.

Like she was watching her own life from far away.

Because her mind—

Her heart—

Was still there.

In that golden field.

With him.

“You’re mine...”

His voice echoed softly in her head.

Her chest tightened instantly.

Her fingers curled into the bedsheet.

“Don’t...” she whispered.

But the memories didn’t stop.

His hand holding hers.

The way he looked at her.

The way he said *‘I’ll wait.’*

Her breathing became uneven.

Tears slipped silently into her pillow.

“I told you not to wait...” she whispered, her voice breaking.

“Why didn’t you listen...?”

Silence answered her.

And that silence—

Hurt more than anything.

She sat up suddenly.

Her head spinning slightly.

“I made the right choice...”

She repeated it.

Again.

And again.

“I had to leave...”

“I had to...”

“I had to...”

But every time she said it—

Her heart disagreed.

Her chest tightened painfully.

Like something inside was tearing slowly.

“What if he’s still there...?” she whispered.

Her eyes filled again.

“Standing in the same place...”

“Waiting...”

The image hit her hard.

Too hard.

“Stop...” she pressed her hand against her chest.

“It’s not real...”

But it felt real.

More real than this.

Her breathing became heavier.

“I can’t go back...”

She shook her head slowly.

“I won’t go back...”

Because if she did—

She knew.

She wouldn’t leave again.

And that scared her.

But staying away...

That was hurting her too.

Her legs felt weak as she stood up.

The room slightly spinning.

Her body felt heavier than before.

She walked to the mirror.

Stopped.

Looked at herself.

Her eyes were dull.

Red.

Tired.

“Who are you...?” she whispered.

Because she didn’t recognize herself anymore.

The girl who smiled.

The girl who laughed.

The girl who felt light—

She wasn’t there.

Only this version remained.

Broken.

Empty.

Her hand slowly touched her reflection.

“I lost him...”

Her voice cracked completely.

“No...” she shook her head.

“I left him.”

That truth—

It hurt more.

Her knees gave in slowly.

She slid down to the floor.

Back against the wall.

Tears fell uncontrollably now.

“I miss you...”

The words came out louder this time.

Desperate.

“I miss you so much...”

Her shoulders trembled.

Her hands shaking.

“I want to come back...”

Silence.

“I want to come back... but I can’t...”

Her voice broke into sobs.

“I’m sorry...”

“I’m so sorry...”

Over and over again.

Like he could hear her.

Like he was still there.

But he wasn’t.

And that was the hardest part.

The day faded into evening.

Evening into night.

Luna lay back on her bed.

Exhausted.

Emotionally drained.

Her eyes stared at the ceiling again.

But this time—

She wasn't waiting.

Her fingers tightened slightly.

“Don't appear...”

She whispered to the empty room.

“Please...”

Tears slipped again.

“Don't make me choose again...”

Because she already knew—

If the door appeared—

She would break.

And this time—

She wouldn't be strong enough to walk away.

Her eyes slowly closed.

Not in peace.

But in pain.

And somewhere—

In a place she refused to return to—

A boy she loved...

Still existed in her memories.

Waiting.

Even if she never went back.